MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-BVOC (HONOURS) Regular EXAMINATION November 2025

First SEMESTER

Skill Development Components (SDC) - MG1SDCBAJ101 -

FUNDAMENTALS OF JOURNALISM

(2025 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Remember(K), Understand(U), Apply(A), Analyse(An), Evaluate(E), Create(C), Skill(S), Interest(I) and Appreciation(Ap)

Students should attempt at least one question from each course outcome to enhance their overall outcome attainability.

Part A

MCQ

Answer all questions

Each question carries 1 marks

Q1. Which quality ensures a journalist reports without personal bias? [U] / [CO1, CO2]

Answer: Objectivity

Q2. Correcting mistakes promptly in news reporting represents: [U] /[CO1]

Answer: Accountability

Q3. Which of the following is NOT hard news? [U] / [CO1, CO2]

Answer: Celebrity's wedding

Q4. The criteria used by journalists to determine news is called: [U] /[CO1,CO2]

Answer: Newsworthiness

Q5. Slander and libel is associated with: [U] / [CO1, CO2]

Answer: Defamation

Q6. Which of the following is the largest news agency in India? [A] / [CO3, CO4]

Answer: PTI

Q7. Which type of editorial uses humour, irony or satire to discuss serious issues? [A]/[CO5]

Answer: Humorous editorial

Q8. Why is brevity important in news editing? [A] / [CO5]

Answer: It saves time and space and keeps the story meaningful.

Q9. A picture that tells the story without needing words is called: [A] / [CO5]

Answer: Standalone news photo

Q10. Which of the following is not a duty of the editor? [A] / [CO5]

Answer: Typing and filing reports

Part B

SHORT ANSWERS

Answer any 5 questions

Each question carries 2 marks

Q11. Explain the term primary news source. [U] / [CO1, CO2]

A primary news source is the original and firsthand source of information used in news reporting. It includes eyewitnesses, interviews, official statements, press conferences, documents, speeches, and direct observations by reporters. Primary sources are important because they ensure accuracy, credibility, and authenticity of news.

Q12. Describe the role of a journalist in society. [U] / [CO1, CO2]

A journalist plays a vital role in society by collecting, verifying, and presenting truthful information to the public. Journalists inform people about current events, educate society on important issues, expose corruption and injustice, and act as watchdogs of democracy. They also give voice to the marginalized and help citizens make informed decisions.

Q13. Describe the key characteristics of radio as a medium. [U] / [CO1]

Radio is an audio-based medium that uses sound, voice, music, and sound effects. It is immediate and allows quick dissemination of news. Radio is portable, affordable, and has wide reach, especially in rural areas. It stimulates the listener's imagination and does not require literacy.

Q14. List any three skills required for a general assignment reporter. [A] / [CO3, CO4]

A general assignment reporter should have strong news sense to identify newsworthy events, good communication skills to report clearly, and effective interviewing skills to gather accurate information. Observation and adaptability are also important skills.

Q15. Why should a newspaper follow consistency in language? [A] / [CO5]

Consistency in language helps maintain clarity and readability throughout the newspaper. It ensures uniform style, avoids confusion among readers, and enhances professionalism and credibility. Consistent language also strengthens the identity of the newspaper.

Q16. Explain why white space is important in the layout of editorial pages. [A] / [CO5]

White space improves readability by preventing overcrowding of text and images. It gives visual balance to the page, helps readers focus on content, and creates a clean and professional appearance for editorial pages.

Q17. Explain skyline headline. [A] / [CO5]

A skyline headline is a headline style in which the first line extends across the full width of the page, while the remaining lines are shorter. It is commonly used for major or lead news stories to attract readers' attention.

Q18. Explain linguistic challenge in translating news content. [A] / [CO6]

Linguistic challenges arise due to differences in grammar, vocabulary, idioms, and cultural meanings between languages. Translating news accurately is difficult because the original meaning, tone, and context must be preserved without distortion or bias.

Part C

SHORT ESSAY

Answer any 3 questions

Each question carries 5 marks

Q19. Explain the different functions of journalism. [U] / [CO1]

Journalism performs several important functions in society. Its main function is to inform the public by providing accurate and timely news. Journalism also educates people by explaining social, political, and economic issues. Another key function is acting as a watchdog by monitoring those in power and exposing corruption and injustice. Journalism also provides a platform for public opinion through editorials and columns. Through these functions, journalism supports democracy and public awareness.

Q20. Illustrate the structure of the inverted pyramid with an example. [A] / [CO3]

The inverted pyramid is a news writing structure where the most important information appears at the beginning of the story. The lead answers the key questions such as who, what, when, where, why, and how. Supporting details follow in the middle, while less important background information comes at the end.

For example, in an accident report, the lead mentions the accident, location, time, and casualties, followed by details and background information.

Q21. Discuss the main departments of a newspaper and their core responsibilities.

[A] / [CO3, CO4]

A newspaper consists of several departments. The editorial department edits news, writes editorials, and decides content. The reporting department gathers news from the field. The advertising department manages advertisements and revenue. The circulation department handles distribution, and the production department manages layout, design, and printing.

Q22. Describe how a journalist should handle difficult or controversial questions during an interview. [A] / [CO4]

A journalist should remain calm, polite, and professional while asking difficult questions. Questions should be factual, relevant, and unbiased. The journalist must listen carefully, avoid arguments, and maintain ethical standards such as fairness and accuracy during the interview.

Q23. Explain how to write an effective lead. [A] / [CO5]

An effective lead is the opening paragraph of a news story that presents the most important information. It should be clear, concise, and interesting. A good lead answers key questions and encourages readers to continue reading the news story.

Part D

ESSAY

Answer any 1 questions

Each question carries 15 marks

Q24. “Reporters are the eyes and ears of a news organization.” Explain the role and responsibilities of a reporter. [A] / [CO3, CO4]

Reporters are called the eyes and ears of a news organization because they collect firsthand information directly from the field. They identify newsworthy events, attend press conferences, conduct interviews, and observe situations. Reporters must verify facts, ensure accuracy, and maintain objectivity in their reports. They follow ethical principles such as truth, fairness, accountability, and respect for privacy. By reporting issues that affect society and holding authorities accountable, reporters play an important role in democracy.

Q25. Discuss the meaning, origin, and evolution of journalism. [U] / [CO1]

Journalism is the process of collecting, verifying, and presenting news and information to the public. It originated from early forms of communication such as town criers and handwritten newsletters. With the invention of the printing press, newspapers developed. Journalism later expanded through radio and television. In the modern era, digital media and online platforms have transformed journalism, making news faster and more accessible while maintaining its core values.